Survival Wolof

The 100 words and phrases to know first

GREETINGS AND BASICS

Salaam aleekum	Hello
Maalekum salaam	Hello (in reply)
Na nga def?	How are you?
Maa ngi fi rekk	I'm fine
Yow nag?	And you?
Naka nga tudd?	What's your name?
Maa ngi tudd Awa	My name is Awa
Jërëjëf	Thank you
Waaw	Yes
Déedéet	No
Ba beneen yoon	See you next time
Fan nga dëkk?	Where do you live?
Fan nga jóge?	Where are you from?
Dégg nga wolof?	Do you understand Wolof?
Dégguma	I don't understand
Waxaatal	Say it again
Waxal ndànk	Speak slowly
Baal ma	Sorry, excuse me
Amul solo	No problem
Dégg naa	I understand
Xamuma	I don't know

COURTESY AND VISITS

Ñoo ko bokk	You're welcome
Dalal ak jàmm	Welcome
Jàmm nga am?	Are you at peace?
Jàmm rekk	Peace only (all is well)
Toogal	Sit down
Kaay lekk!	Come and eat!
Suur naa	I'm full
Neex na lool	It's really delicious
teraanga	hospitality
Maa ngi dem	I'm leaving

NUMBERS AND MONEY

benn	one
ñaar	two
ñett	three
ñeent	four
juróom	five
fukk	ten
ñaar-fukk	twenty
téeméer	one hundred
junni	one thousand
Ñaata la?	How much is it?
xaalis	money
Amuma xaalis	I don't have money
Jox ma	Give me
Dafa seer!	It's expensive!
Wàññi ko tuuti	Lower the price a little

FOOD AND DRINK

ndox	water
mburu	bread
ceeb	rice
jën	fish
Dama xiif	I'm hungry
Dama mar	I'm thirsty
Dama bëgg ndox	I want water
Neex na!	It's delicious!
Amul	There isn't any
Ana wanag wi?	Where is the toilet?

GETTING AROUND

Fan ngay dem?	Where are you going?
Ana marse bi?	Where is the market?
fii	here
fale	there
càmmoñ	left
ndeyjoor	right
Jubal	Go straight on
Dafa sore	It's far
Dafa jege	It's near
Taxawal fii	Stop here
taksi	taxi
garaas	bus station
loppitaan	hospital
Dama bëgg dem	I want to go
Fan ngay tukki?	Where are you travelling to?

TIME

tey	today
suba	tomorrow
démb	yesterday
Ban waxtu moo jot?	What time is it?
léegi	now
Kañ?	When?
Ban waxtu?	What time?
Baax na	OK, that's fine

HEALTH AND EMERGENCIES

Ndax mën nga ma dimbali?	Can you help me?
Dama feebar	I'm ill
Sama bopp dafay metti	My head hurts
Sama biir dafay metti	My stomach hurts
doktoor	doctor
Wool doktoor!	Call a doctor!
Am nga garab?	Do you have medicine?
Wér naa	I'm well (healthy)
Dama sonn	I'm tired

QUESTIONS AND PLANS

Lii lan la?	What is this?
Lan nga bëgg?	What do you want?
Kii kan la?	Who is this?
Lu tax?	Why?
Ndax dinga ñëw?	Will you come?
Mënuma ñëw	I can't come
Ñu dem!	Let's go!
Dinaa ñëw	I will come
Lan ngay liggéey?	What's your job?
Summil sa dàll	Take off your shoes
Dafay taw	It's raining
Dafa tàng	It's hot

HOW TO READ WOLOF

c	ch as in church
j	j as in jam
x	throaty h, as in Scottish loch
ñ	ny as in canyon
ŋ	ng as in sing
ë	u as in but
aa, ee…	doubled vowels are long
u	oo as in food

ETIQUETTE IN BRIEF

- **Greeting the right way.** Always greet before anything else, even in a shop or an office. Shake hands with your right hand; with someone of the opposite sex, wait for them to offer theirs.
- **Ramadan and prayer.** During Ramadan, avoid eating, drinking or smoking in public in the daytime. Don't walk in front of someone who is praying, and dress modestly near mosques.
- **Being a good guest.** Meals are often shared from one big bowl: wash your hands, eat with your right hand from the part in front of you, and let the host share out the meat.